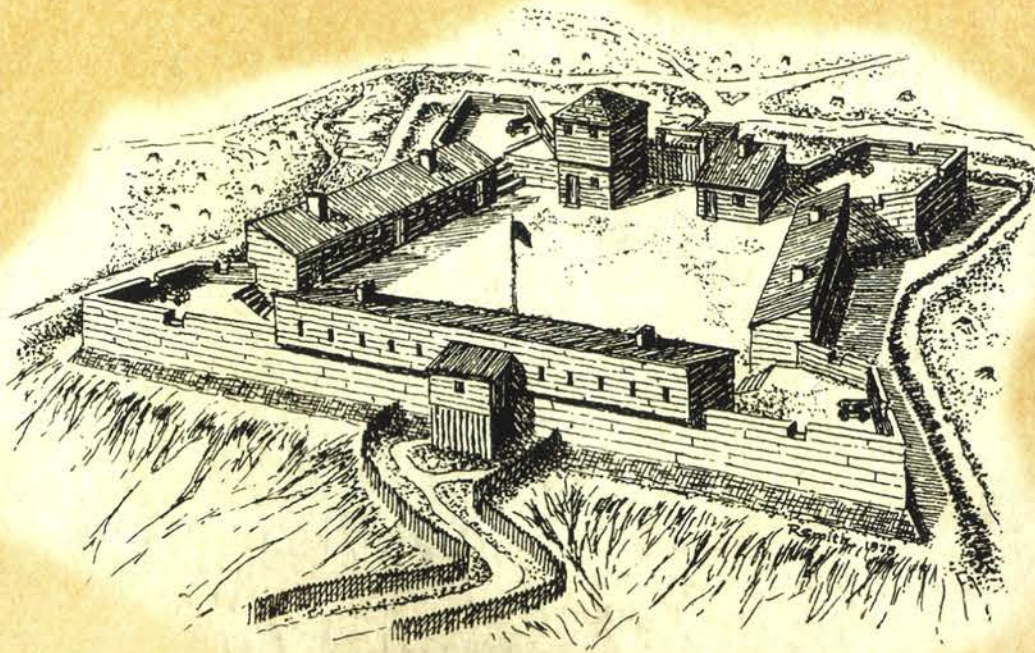




Beaver's Fort McIntosh – 'A Unique Place in American History'

On Saturday, May 7, 2011, the Beaver Area Heritage Foundation dedicated the Fort McIntosh Monument, at a very special site in Beaver, our County seat – the following historical excerpt appeared in the program on dedication day.

Fort McIntosh was built on this site in the autumn of 1778 by General Lachian McIntosh, Commander of the Western Continental Army under General George Washington. The fort had two purposes: To defend the territory northwest of the Ohio River, and to become the first in a chain of forts intended to dislodge the British from their stronghold at Fort Detroit. This was important because the British were supporting the Indians who occupied these lands and who were marauding the American settlers west of the Allegheny Mountains. Immediately after the completion of this fort, McIntosh proceeded west to the banks of the Tuscarawas River in Ohio, and built Fort Laurens, planned to become the second for in the chain. The Fort McIntosh site was recovered and redefined by an archaeological study completed in 1978 by the Beaver Area Heritage Foundation.

1st American Regiment

Following the end of the Revolutionary War in 1783, the Continental Army was soon disbanded, which left the western frontier unguarded and subject to many deadly raids upon settlers by the Indians. To cope with this serious problem, the Congress

authorized the formation of a small military force to help guard the western frontier and certain other military installations. This was undertaken in 1784 with the appointments of Col. Josiah Harmar, who was to raise a standing army of up to 700 troops for this purpose. By the end of the year, about half the number had been enlisted, and most of these were assigned to Fort McIntosh, to provide security for an upcoming Treaty congregation with the Indians, which took place in January, 1785. Col Harmar named this the First American Regiment, now known as the President's Guard, also respectfully referred to as the Old Guard Regiment.

The Bridge and the County Commissioners wish to acknowledge Bob Smith for this historical contribution. For many years Bob Smith has been actively associated with the Beaver Area Heritage Foundation in many capacities, including research, writing, illustration, program presentations and administration. He is co-author of the book 'Beaver Town – 2002,' and for many years wrote 'Foundations,' the periodic newsletter of the Heritage Foundation. He is a retired Communication Director of the Michael Baker Corporation and former Executive Director of the Beaver County Educational Trust.